

Social Video

Newmark Graduate School of Journalism

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John Smock

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John Smock

he/him/his

john.smock@journalism.cuny.edu

Room: 444

Thurs, 9:30a - 12:20p

Office hours: by appt.

COURSE DESCRIPTION

The term “social video” describes short-form visual stories made up of a broad swath of ever-evolving media elements, styles and formats presented on an equally varied number of platforms. Nowhere else in visual journalism are the changes in our industry playing out as dramatically as they are in social video.

This course is designed as a hands-on laboratory for students to explore the format(s) that make up social video and the tools used to produce them. More than simply teach a specific formula for production, the course is designed to teach students to adapt in a rapidly changing professional world and prepare you to be an innovator.

The ten-week module will include several smaller, weekly assignments and at least one longer group project for a school-sponsored social site such as [New York Focus](#). Students are expected to pitch and produce multiple assignments for this course. Each week a new construction element of social video production will be introduced. Students will be given time during class to work on related assignments. In some cases those assignments will be turned in the following week. Students are also expected to read/view assigned course material, contribute to “film festivals” and to class discussion.

Students are expected to have a basic competency with [Adobe Premiere Pro](#). We will also use tools such as Adobe Photoshop, EZGIF, CapCut Instagram Edits and others.

OUTCOMES

Students who complete this course can expect to develop the following skills:

- **Identify, create and publish** engaging social story ideas
- **Use of mobile phones** to produce professional caliber visual content
- **Use of mobile gear** such as wireless mics, ring lights, gimbals and green screen
- **Use of Adobe Premiere** (and Photoshop) along with a suite of other tools to produce social videos.
- **Pitch social story** concepts to professional outlets
- **Use of text, graphics and found/archival material** as a content element in social

stories

- **Techniques for distribution** of social videos on a variety of social media platforms
- **Comprehend** the contemporary and ever-changing professional use of social video

GRADING

Grades for the course will be broken down as follows:

- Early in-class assignments (5x5s): **30 percent**
- Two social stories (one individual project, one group project): **40 percent**
- Class participation (including online discussions, professionalism and attendance): **30 percent**

* **REVISIONS:** Students have one week from the time you receive feedback on assignments to revise and assignment. Your final grade on an assignment will be the average number between the original grade and your revision.

Grading Rubric:

- **The assignment was pitched, produced and filed on time and as instructed** - Story is properly developed from pitch to production. Assignment fulfills instructions. Filed by Deadline(s). Properly named and filed correctly. (25 percent)
- **The assignments is technically proficient.** Footage is focused and properly exposed. Audio is is clear. Graphics/Text elements function properly. (25 percent)
- **The assignment clearly tells a story.** Clips are varied and well-sequenced to create a narrative. Audio, graphic and text elements work to enhance visual narrative (25 percent)
- **The assignment demonstrates effort and creativity.** The story is creative, well-executed and compelling. The story received exemplary feedback from other students during review. (25 percent..)

Attendance in the course is mandatory. See the [ACADEMIC CALENDAR](#) for the spring course schedule. Students who must miss a course should notify me beforehand. Special presentations may be considered for extra credit.

Plagiarism, copyright violation and fabrication are not permitted. You may not use copyrighted material without permission and attribution. In some cases, small samples of copyrighted material are permitted. We will discuss. If you have doubts or questions about something you're considering, please discuss with the instructor.

Support for diversity/inclusion in news coverage and in newsrooms is a fundamental value of the school and this course. Students, guest speakers and the instructor must all be comfortable discussing issues related to diversity. If something is said or done that a student feels is in violation of this principle please let me know or the Office of Academic Affairs aware.

It is school policy to provide Accommodations and Academic Adjustments ([CUNY policy](#)) to students with disabilities. Any student who has a disability who may need accommodations in this class should register as early as possible with the Office of Student Affairs in Room 307. Because of continued concern about Covid, health and personal safety remain important this semester. If you don't feel well, let me know and don't come to school. Zoom remains an option. If you test positive please let administration know.

ASSIGNMENTS

This course is intended as a hands-on laboratory for the development of social media stories and a tool kit for building stories. We will take a learn-as-we go approach. Each class time will be allotted for the production of weekly exercises/assignments. Students will also produce three (or four) social videos for publication.. Students are also expected to [contribute to regular "film festivals"](#) where we will discuss examples of professional work.

COURSE SCHEDULE

DAY ONE (9/3) - Introductions and basic production skills

- Intros: Syllabus, course expectations
- From YouTube to IG to TikTok and the cover of the New York Times, what the heck is social video and what does it mean for journalism?
- Using the social video kit
- The 5x5
- [The Film Festival](#)

Day TWO (9/10) - Text and Social Video

- The all-important hook
- Adobe Premiere for text: transcription and text as a graphic element
- Working with keyframes in Adobe Premiere
- The social media bio
- Pitch First Group Project

Day THREE (9/17) - Audio and Social Video

- Chromakey (green screen) and lighting
- Working with Audio
 - VO, narration and reading from a script/teleprompter
 - Levels
 - Nat Sound
 - Music
- In-class "This day in history" exercise with chromakey
- Speaker: NY in Focus
- Group Project

Day FOUR (9/24) - Painting a More Visual Picture with Stills

- Using still images in social stories
- Animations and language
- SPEAKER (pre-recorded, Delia Pauneacu)
- Submit Rough Cut of Group Project
- Introduction of Group Project
- [The Film Festival](#)

Day FIVE (10/1) - Using Archival/Found Footage

- Sources and best practice for archival/found footage
- Copyright, fair use and the public domain
- Semiotics and the language of social video
- Assignment: Group Project

Day SIX(10/8) - GIFs, Animations, and other graphic content

- Producing the GIF/animation
- SPEAKER: Tristan Werkmeister from Reuters
- Pitch the final project of the news service

Day SEVEN ** (10/15) - GIFs, Animations, and other graphic content, Part II

- GIFs, animations and graphics revisited
- Assignment (final project)

Day EIGHT ** (10/22) - Professional Strategies for Social Video

- Submit Story #3
- Studio lighting (reporter videos)
- Workshop Time

Day NINE (10/29) - The Final Project

- AI Resources for Social Vid
- Workshop time
- What's next in social video

Day TEN (11/5) - Review of Final Projects

- Submit Story #4
- Final review and summary